



Mavilo Pet Co.

HAPPY PETS, PRACTICAL CARE

PRINTABLE GUIDE



A POSITIVE-REINFORCEMENT PROGRAM



The 30-Day Puppy Training Plan

Short, fun daily sessions that build a confident, polite puppy — from name recognition and potty training to a reliable recall and a loose leash.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- Week-by-week skill plan
- Potty & crate training schedules
- Bite inhibition made simple
- Socialization checklist
- 30-day daily plan table
- Troubleshooting FAQ
- Printable progress tracker
- Tips for the whole family



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HOW TO USE THIS PDF

Read it on screen or print the whole thing. Worksheet pages are designed to be printed again and again, so feel free to print extra copies of any tracker you use often. Tip: print at “Actual size” on US Letter paper.

Welcome & How This Plan Works

Congratulations on your new puppy! The next 30 days are a wonderful window to build habits that last a lifetime.

This plan gives you a clear, day-by-day path through the skills most families want first: responding to their name, sitting, lying down, staying, coming when called, walking nicely on a leash, using the right potty spot, relaxing in a crate, and using a gentle mouth. You only need **three to five short sessions a day of 3–5 minutes each**, woven into normal life.

The positive-reinforcement approach

Positive reinforcement means you **add something your puppy likes (a treat, a toy, praise, access to the yard) right after a behavior you want**, so that behavior happens more often. It is the approach recommended by the American Veterinary Society of Animal Behavior because it builds trust and avoids the fear and side effects that can come with harsh corrections.

Reward what you like

Catch your puppy doing things right — sitting calmly, chewing their own toy, lying on their mat — and pay for it.

Prevent what you don't

Use gates, pens, leashes and supervision so unwanted habits never get practiced. Management is not cheating; it's smart.

Redirect, don't punish

If your puppy makes a mistake, calmly interrupt and show them what to do instead. Yelling or physical corrections tend to create fear, not understanding.

Keep it short and happy

End every session while your puppy still wants more. Five great repetitions beat twenty sloppy ones.

Your two most important tools

1. A marker word (or clicker)

A marker is a short, consistent signal — the word **“Yes!”** or the sound of a clicker — that means “that exact thing you just did earns a reward.” Mark the instant the behavior happens, then deliver the treat within a second or two. You'll “charge” your marker on Day 1.

2. Tiny, tasty treats

Use pea-sized pieces (about the size of a pencil eraser for small breeds). Mix a portion of your puppy's daily kibble with a few higher-value treats such as small bits of plain cooked chicken. Count training treats as part of the daily food amount so your puppy stays at a healthy weight — a common guideline is to keep treats to about 10% of daily calories.

REWARD LADDER

Low value: kibble, praise • **Medium:** commercial soft training treats • **High:** chicken, cheese bits, a favorite tug toy. Use higher-value rewards for harder skills and busier places.

Is my puppy ready?

This plan suits puppies roughly **8 to 20 weeks old**, and works just as well for older puppies and newly adopted adult dogs — simply move at your dog's pace. If a step feels hard, go back to the last step that was easy and make it a little easier.

Before Day 1: Set Up for Success

A little preparation makes the whole month smoother for you and your puppy.

Training supply checklist

- ☐ Treat pouch or apron with pockets
- ☐ Pea-sized soft treats + kibble
- ☐ Clicker (optional)
- ☐ Flat collar or harness with ID tag
- ☐ 6-ft leash (not retractable for training)
- ☐ 15–30 ft long line for recall practice
- ☐ Crate sized so puppy can stand, turn and lie down (use a divider)
- ☐ Baby gates and/or exercise pen
- ☐ Mat or bed for “settle” practice
- ☐ Enzymatic cleaner for accidents
- ☐ Chew toys: rubber, food-stuffable, soft plush
- ☐ Poop bags

Family agreement

Consistency speeds learning. Agree on these before Day 1 and post them on the fridge.

Decision	Our answer
Marker word	
Potty cue (e.g. “Go potty”)	
Recall word	
Release word (e.g. “Free!”)	
Allowed on furniture?	
Where puppy sleeps	
Who handles AM / PM potty trips	
Off-limits rooms	

Session basics

- **Length:** 3–5 minutes, 3–5 times a day. Puppies learn best in short bursts with rest in between; sleep helps them consolidate new skills.
- **Timing:** Train before meals (a little hungry = motivated) and after a potty break and a short play session (not over-excited).
- **Location:** Start in a quiet room. Add new places and distractions only after a skill is solid at home.
- **Success rate:** Aim for about 80% success. If your puppy gets it wrong twice in a row, make it easier.
- **Cues:** Say a cue once. If your puppy doesn’t respond, help them (lure or reset) instead of repeating “sit, sit, SIT.”
- **Rest:** Young puppies often need 18–20 hours of sleep a day. An overtired puppy is a bitey puppy — schedule naps.

THE 3 D’S

Every skill gets harder as you increase **Duration** (how long), **Distance** (how far you are) or **Distraction** (what else is happening). Raise only *one* D at a time, and lower the others when you do.

Week 1: Foundations

Days 1–7 • Goals: charge the marker, name recognition, potty and crate routines, gentle handling.

Skill 1 — Charging the marker (Day 1)

- 1 Sit with a handful of treats. Say “Yes!” in a happy voice, then immediately give a treat. Your puppy doesn’t have to do anything.
- 2 Repeat 10–15 times per session, two sessions. Vary the pause between repetitions so it’s the word, not your hand moving, that predicts food.
- 3 Test: when your puppy is looking away, say “Yes!” If their head whips toward you, the marker is charged.

Skill 2 — Name recognition

- 1 When your puppy is close and not too distracted, say their name once in a cheerful tone.
- 2 The moment they look at you, mark “Yes!” and treat.
- 3 Repeat 5–10 times per session. Gradually say the name when your puppy is sniffing or a few feet away.
- 4 Protect the name: never use it to scold or before something unpleasant (like nail trims). You want the name to always mean “good things happen when you look at me.”

Skill 3 — “Check-ins” (capturing attention)

All week, whenever your puppy chooses to look at you without being asked, mark and reward. This builds a puppy who naturally orients to you — the foundation for leash walking and recall.

Skill 4 — Gentle handling

Pair touch with treats so vet visits and grooming are easy later. Touch an ear → treat. Lift a paw for one second → treat. Peek at the teeth → treat. Keep it to a few seconds per body part and stop before your puppy wiggles away.

Routines to start this week

Potty

Follow the schedule on the *Potty Training Schedule* page: out on waking, after eating, after playing, after naps, and every 1–2 hours while awake.

Crate

Complete crate steps 1–3 (see *Crate Training*): feed meals near and then inside the crate, toss treats in, and let your puppy explore with the door open.

Settle on a mat

Drop treats on a mat whenever your puppy steps on or lies on it. By the end of the week, many puppies will go to their mat on their own.

Socialization

Begin 2–3 gentle new experiences a day from the *Socialization Checklist*, always at your puppy's comfort level.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK

✓ Puppy orients to the marker word ✓ Looks at you when you say their name in a quiet room ✓ Walks into the crate for a treat ✓ Accepts a brief paw and ear touch

Week 2: Sit, Down & Gentle Mouths

Days 8–14 • Goals: sit and down on a verbal cue, release word, bite inhibition basics.

Sit

- 1 **Lure:** Hold a treat at your puppy's nose and slowly move it up and slightly back over their head. As the nose rises, the rear lowers. The instant their bottom touches the floor, mark "Yes!" and treat.
- 2 **Fade the lure:** After 5–8 successful reps, make the same hand motion with no treat in that hand. Mark and reward from your other hand or pouch.
- 3 **Add the cue:** Once your puppy sits reliably as your hand moves, say "Sit" *just before* the hand signal. Over several sessions, make the hand signal smaller.
- 4 **Release:** Say your release word ("Free!") and toss a treat a step away so your puppy gets up. The release word tells your puppy when the sit is over.

Down

- 1 Start with your puppy sitting. Hold a treat at their nose and slowly move it straight down to the floor between their front paws, then slowly out along the floor.
- 2 Mark and treat the moment their elbows touch the floor. If they stand up, just reset and try a slower lure.
- 3 Still stuck? Sit on the floor with one knee raised and lure your puppy under your leg, or **capture** the behavior: mark and treat whenever your puppy lies down on their own.
- 4 Fade the lure and add the verbal cue exactly as you did for Sit.

SIT AS "PLEASE"

Ask for a quick sit before good things: before the food bowl goes down, before the door opens, before a toss of the ball. Your puppy learns that polite behavior makes life's good things happen.

Gentle mouths this week

Puppies explore the world with their mouths, and nipping peaks around 3–5 months. This week, start the steps on the *Bite Inhibition* page: keep chew toys everywhere, pause play when teeth touch skin, and give plenty of nap time.

Keep practicing

- Name game in new rooms and in the yard
- Crate steps 4–5: short door-closed sessions with a food-stuffed toy
- Handling: brush a few strokes, touch each nail, wipe paws with a towel
- Potty: start adding your potty cue just as your puppy begins to go

END-OF-WEEK CHECK

✓ Sits on a verbal cue in 2+ rooms ✓ Lies down with a small hand signal ✓ Understands the release word ✓ Relaxes in crate with the door closed for a few minutes

Week 3: Stay & Come

Days 15–21 • Goals: a short stay with you nearby and a joyful recall indoors and in the yard.

Stay (build the 3 D's one at a time)

- 1 **Duration:** Ask for a sit. Wait 1 second, mark, treat *while they're still sitting*, then release. Build to 2, 3, 5, then 10 seconds. Vary the times so it isn't always harder.
- 2 **Add the word:** Once your puppy can hold a sit for 5 seconds, say "Stay" with a flat-hand signal before you start counting.
- 3 **Distance:** Go back to a 2-second stay. Lean back, then take one step away and immediately return, treat, release. Build to 2 steps, 3 steps, then walking to the edge of the room.
- 4 **Distraction:** Back at short duration and close distance, add small distractions: bounce once on your toes, clap softly, drop a (non-food) item.
- 5 **Always return and release:** Walk back to your puppy to reward, then release. Don't call your puppy out of a stay yet — that blurs stay and come.

Come (recall)

A reliable recall can keep your dog safe. The secret is making your recall word the best news your puppy ever hears.

- 1 **Charge the recall word:** Say "Come!" (or "Here!") and give a high-value treat right away, 10 times. No movement required.
- 2 **Short-distance recall:** From 3–4 feet away, say your puppy's name + recall word, then back up a few steps. Mark as they reach you, treat at your belly, and gently touch their collar before releasing to play again.
- 3 **Ping-pong recall:** Two people sit across a room and take turns calling the puppy. Great fun and great practice.
- 4 **Hide and seek:** Step behind a door and call. Throw a small party (treats, praise, play) when your puppy finds you.
- 5 **Outdoors:** Practice in a fenced yard or on a 15–30 ft long line — never off-leash in an unfenced area at this stage.

RECALL GOLDEN RULES

- Never call your puppy for something they dislike (bath, ending play, crating right away). Go get them instead.
- Never punish a puppy who comes to you — no matter how long it took.
- Call once. If they don't come, make yourself interesting (crouch, run away, squeak) rather than repeating.

EMERGENCY RECALL

Consider a second, special recall word (like "Pizza!") that is *only ever* followed by a jackpot of 5–10 amazing treats. Practice it a few times a week and save it for real emergencies.

Week 4: Leash Walking & Real Life

Days 22–30 • Goals: loose-leash walking basics and practicing every skill in new places.

Loose-leash walking

Puppies pull because pulling works — it gets them where they want to go. Our goal is to teach that a loose leash is what makes walks happen.

- 1 **Reward position indoors:** With your puppy off-leash in a hallway, walk a few steps. Every time they are next to your leg, mark and deliver the treat right at your pant seam. Decide on a side (left is traditional) and stay consistent.
- 2 **Add the leash:** Clip on a 6-ft leash and repeat. Reward every 1–2 steps at first, then every 3–5 steps as your puppy improves.
- 3 **Be a tree:** If the leash goes tight, stop and stand still. The instant the leash loosens (your puppy steps back or looks at you), mark and treat, then move forward again.
- 4 **Change direction:** If your puppy keeps pulling toward something, cheerfully say “This way!” and walk the other direction. Reward when they catch up beside you.
- 5 **Sniff breaks:** Give permission to sniff (“Go sniff!”) as a reward for a stretch of loose-leash walking. Sniffing is important mental exercise.

HARNESS TIP

A well-fitted front-clip harness can reduce pulling while your puppy learns. Avoid choke, prong and shock collars, which rely on discomfort and can cause fear or injury.

Proofing: practicing everywhere

Dogs don’t generalize well. A puppy who sits perfectly in the kitchen may seem to “forget” in the park. That’s normal! Re-teach each skill in each new place, starting easy.

Level	Where to practice	Tips
Easy	Every room of the house	Use lower-value treats; short sessions
Medium	Backyard, driveway, quiet sidewalk	Use higher-value treats; expect a small dip in performance
Harder	Pet-friendly store, park edge, near a school at pickup time	Stay far enough from distractions that your puppy can still eat and respond

Life-skill bonus games

Wait at doors

Hand on the door; open an inch. If the puppy moves forward, close it. When they hold still, open and release. Great for safety.

Leave it

Treat in a closed fist. Ignore licking; the instant they back off, mark and reward from the *other* hand. Add the cue once reliable.

Trade / drop

Offer a treat in exchange for a toy, then give the toy back. Your puppy learns giving things up is a good deal.

DAY 30 GRADUATION

Celebrate! Most puppies won't be perfect by Day 30 — and that's fine. What matters is that you have a puppy who loves learning and a routine you can keep building on. Consider a positive-reinforcement puppy class next.

Potty Training Schedule

Success comes from frequent trips outside, rewarding the right spot, and preventing accidents.

When to take your puppy out

- ☐ Right after waking up (morning and every nap)
- ☐ Within 5–30 minutes after eating or drinking
- ☐ During and after play or excitement
- ☐ After coming out of the crate
- ☐ Right before bedtime
- ☐ Every 1–2 hours while awake (young puppies)
- ☐ Any time you see sniffing, circling or wandering off

How long can my puppy hold it?

A common rule of thumb is **about one hour per month of age, plus one**, during the day (a 3-month-old: about 3–4 hours at most). Many puppies can hold it longer overnight once settled. Every puppy is different, so use this as an upper limit, not a goal.

The potty trip, step by step

- 1 Leash your puppy and walk to the *same* potty spot each time.
- 2 Stand quietly. Say your potty cue once as they start sniffing.
- 3 As they finish, mark “Yes!” and give a treat right there (not back inside).
- 4 Reward with a few minutes of sniffing or play.
- 5 No potty in 5 minutes? Back in the crate or pen for 10–15 minutes, then try again.

Sample day for a 10–12 week puppy

Time	Activity
6:30 AM	Wake → straight outside to potty spot → reward
6:45 AM	Breakfast (in crate or on a mat) → potty trip 10–20 min later
7:15 AM	Play + 3-minute training session → potty
8:00 AM	Nap in crate or pen (1–2 hrs) → potty on waking
10:00 AM	Socialization outing or yard exploration → potty
11:30 AM	Lunch → potty → nap
2:00 PM	Potty → training session → chew time
4:00 PM	Potty → play → nap
5:30 PM	Dinner → potty → family time on leash or in pen
7:30 PM	Potty → calm chew → last small drink of water about 1–2 hrs before bed
10:00 PM	Final potty trip → bedtime in crate
Overnight	Young puppies may need one quiet trip out (set an alarm, keep it boring, straight back to bed)

IF AN ACCIDENT HAPPENS

- Calmly interrupt (“Oops!”) and take puppy outside.
- Never scold or rub their nose in it — it teaches them to hide when they go.
- Clean with an **enzymatic cleaner** to remove the scent that attracts repeat visits.
- Ask yourself what to change: more supervision, more frequent trips?

WHEN TO CALL THE VET

Straining, very frequent urination, blood in urine or stool, diarrhea, or sudden setbacks after progress can signal a medical issue such as a urinary tract infection. This guide is general education, not veterinary advice; consult your veterinarian.

Crate Training Step by Step

A crate should feel like a cozy den, never a punishment. Go at your puppy's pace.

Used kindly, a crate helps with potty training, keeps a curious puppy safe when you can't supervise, and gives them a quiet place to rest. Choose a crate your adult dog can stand, turn around and lie down in, and use a divider so your puppy has just enough room right now.

- 1 **Make it inviting.** Put the crate in a room where the family spends time. Add a washable bed and a chew toy. Leave the door open (secure it so it can't swing shut).
- 2 **Treat trail.** Toss treats near, then just inside, then at the back of the crate. Let your puppy go in and come out freely. Mark and reward any choice to step inside.
- 3 **Meals in the crate.** Feed meals just inside the crate, then gradually at the back. Door stays open.
- 4 **Door closed briefly.** While your puppy eats, close the door, then open it as soon as they finish. Gradually leave it closed for a minute or two after the meal.
- 5 **Stuffed-toy sessions.** Give a food-stuffed toy in the crate with the door closed while you sit nearby for 5–10 minutes. Open the door while your puppy is still calm.
- 6 **Walk away.** Sit nearby, then move around the room, then leave the room for short periods. Return before your puppy gets upset.
- 7 **Nap time and bedtime.** Use the crate for naps after play and potty. At night, placing the crate near your bed at first helps many puppies settle.

How long in the crate?

Puppy age	Typical daytime maximum (awake, between potty breaks)
8–10 weeks	30–60 minutes, except while napping
11–14 weeks	1–3 hours
15–16 weeks	3–4 hours
4+ months	Up to about 4 hours; puppies should not be crated all day

If you work long hours, plan for a midday potty and play break (a family member, neighbor or pet sitter).

WHINING IN THE CRATE

First, rule out a potty need: take your puppy out on leash, keep it boring, and bring them back. If they just want out, wait for a few seconds of quiet before opening the door so you reward calm, not noise. Next time, make the step easier.

NEVER

- Use the crate as punishment
- Leave collars with dangling tags on in the crate (snag risk)
- Crate a puppy who is panicking, drooling or trying to escape — ask your vet or a certified trainer about separation distress

Bite Inhibition & Nipping

Puppy nipping is normal. Our job is to teach a soft mouth and better outlets.

Bite inhibition is a dog's learned ability to control the force of their mouth. Puppies learn it from littermates and from us. A dog with good bite inhibition is much less likely to cause injury if they ever feel scared or hurt as an adult, so this is one of the most important things you'll teach.

The four-part plan

1. Give better options

Keep a chew toy within arm's reach in every room. When your puppy reaches for hands, offer the toy instead. Rotate textures: rubber, rope, soft plush, and food-stuffable toys.

2. Pause when teeth touch skin

If teeth press hard, say "Oops" calmly, remove your hand and pause play for 10–20 seconds. Then resume gently. Play stops when mouths get rough; play continues with soft mouths.

3. Step away if it continues

If nipping continues, step behind a gate for 30–60 seconds. This is a calm pause, not a scolding. Come back and offer a toy.

4. Meet the underlying need

Most "shark mode" episodes happen when puppies are overtired, over-excited, hungry or bored. Build a nap, a chew or a sniffy walk into the schedule.

Play that teaches control

- **Tug with rules:** Invite tug with a long toy. Every so often, ask for a "drop" by offering a treat, then restart the game. If teeth hit skin, the game ends briefly.
- **Flirt pole (gently):** A toy on a rope keeps teeth far from hands. Keep the toy low and moves gentle for young joints.
- **Calm hand-feeding:** Feed some kibble from your flat palm. Only hand it over when the puppy takes it softly.

Teething timeline

Puppies typically begin losing baby teeth around 3–4 months, with adult teeth mostly in by about 6–7 months. Chewing often increases during this time. Chilled (not frozen-solid) rubber toys or a damp washcloth that has been refrigerated can soothe sore gums.

AVOID

- Holding the mouth shut, tapping the nose or “alpha rolls” — these can frighten puppies and make biting worse.
- Rough wrestling with hands.
- Letting children run from a nipping puppy (it becomes a chase game). Teach kids to “be a tree.”

GET HELP IF

Your puppy growls, freezes or stiffens when guarding food or toys, bites hard enough to break skin repeatedly, or seems fearful when biting. Talk with your veterinarian and a certified behavior professional (look for CPDT-KA, KPA-CTP, IAABC or a veterinary behaviorist).

Socialization Checklist

Socialization is about creating *positive* experiences with the world — not just exposure.

Puppies have a sensitive period for socialization that runs from roughly **3 to 14–16 weeks of age**. Calm, happy experiences during this window help prevent fear later in life. Pair every new thing with treats and let your puppy choose to approach or watch from a distance. Check a box each time you complete an experience (aim for 3 good experiences each).

Health note: Ask your veterinarian how to socialize safely before your puppy is fully vaccinated. Many vets and the American Veterinary Society of Animal Behavior support well-run puppy classes and carefully chosen outings before the vaccine series is complete, while avoiding high-risk areas such as dog parks and places where unknown dogs eliminate. This guide is general education, not veterinary advice; consult your veterinarian.

People

Experience	1	2	3
Men with beards/hats	☐	☐	☐
Women in sunglasses	☐	☐	☐
Children (calm, supervised)	☐	☐	☐
Toddlers (at a distance)	☐	☐	☐
Older adults / people with canes	☐	☐	☐
People in uniforms or helmets	☐	☐	☐
People in wheelchairs	☐	☐	☐
Delivery drivers	☐	☐	☐
Groups of people talking	☐	☐	☐
People wearing backpacks	☐	☐	☐

Animals

Experience	1	2	3
Calm, vaccinated adult dog	☐	☐	☐
Puppy playdate (similar size)	☐	☐	☐
Cats (from a distance)	☐	☐	☐
Birds / squirrels (watching)	☐	☐	☐
Small pets (safely separated)	☐	☐	☐
Farm or horse smells (if relevant)	☐	☐	☐

Sounds

Experience	1	2	3
Vacuum cleaner	☐	☐	☐
Doorbell / knocking	☐	☐	☐
Thunder (recording, low volume)	☐	☐	☐
Fireworks (recording, low volume)	☐	☐	☐
Traffic & trucks	☐	☐	☐
Hair dryer	☐	☐	☐
Kids playing	☐	☐	☐
Sirens (recording)	☐	☐	☐

Surfaces

Experience	1	2	3
Grass	☐	☐	☐
Gravel	☐	☐	☐
Tile / slick floors	☐	☐	☐
Metal grate	☐	☐	☐
Wet surfaces	☐	☐	☐
Stairs (a few, supervised)	☐	☐	☐
Wobbly board / cushion	☐	☐	☐
Car ramp or step	☐	☐	☐

Places

Experience	1	2	3
Car rides (short)	☐	☐	☐
Pet-friendly store	☐	☐	☐
Vet clinic "happy visit"	☐	☐	☐
Groomer lobby visit	☐	☐	☐
Busy sidewalk (at a distance)	☐	☐	☐
Friend's home	☐	☐	☐
Park bench people-watching	☐	☐	☐

Handling

Experience	1	2	3
Paws & nails touched	☐	☐	☐
Ears looked into	☐	☐	☐
Mouth opened / teeth touched	☐	☐	☐
Brushed	☐	☐	☐
Towel dried	☐	☐	☐
Collar grabbed gently	☐	☐	☐
Picked up / lifted (small breeds)	☐	☐	☐
Stethoscope-style chest touch	☐	☐	☐

READ YOUR PUPPY

Relaxed: loose body, soft eyes, sniffing, taking treats. **Worried:** tail tucked, lip licking, yawning, turning away, refusing food, trying to hide. If you see worry, add distance and try again another day at an easier level.

The 30-Day Daily Plan

3–5 sessions of 3–5 minutes a day. Tick the last box when the day is done — and don't worry if you need to repeat a day.

Day	Training focus	Crate	Potty	Socialization	Done
1	Charge marker (2×15 reps); name game	Crate step 1–2	Out every 1–2 hrs + after meals/naps/play	Home sounds, new family members	☐
2	Name game in 2 rooms; capture check-ins	Crate step 2 (treat trail)	Start potty log	Handling: paws & ears	☐
3	Name game + mat settling	Meals near/inside crate	Same potty spot every time	Car sitting (engine off)	☐
4	Check-ins; handling with treats	Meals at back of crate	Reward within 2 seconds	New surfaces in yard	☐
5	Name game with mild distraction	Door closed during meal	Add overnight trip if needed	Vacuum (off, then on far away)	☐
6	Mat settle for 30 sec	Door closed 1–2 min after meal	Review log for patterns	Calm visitor with treats	☐
7	Review week 1 skills; play!	Nap in crate after play	Celebrate progress	Short car ride	☐
8	Sit — lure (3 sessions)	Stuffed toy in crate, 5 min	Begin saying potty cue	Hats / sunglasses people	☐
9	Sit — fade lure; release word	Stuffed toy, 10 min, you nearby	Keep 1–2 hr schedule	Doorbell sound at low volume	☐
10	Sit — add verbal cue	Leave room briefly	Note accident times	Gravel & wet grass	☐
11	Down — lure	Crate naps	Take out before excitement	Puppy class or safe playdate	☐
12	Down — fade lure	Leave room 2–5 min	Praise + treat at spot	Brushing & towel drying	☐
13	Sit/down in new rooms; hand-feeding	Bedtime routine in crate	Last water 1–2 hrs before bed	Pet-friendly store (carried/cart if advised)	☐
14	Review sit, down, release; tug with rules	Crate while you shower	Review log	Vet happy visit	☐
15	Stay — duration 1–5 sec	Crate with radio on	Stretch gaps slightly if dry	Kids at a distance	☐

Day	Training focus	Crate	Potty	Socialization	Done
16	Stay — add cue; charge recall word	Leave room 5–10 min	Potty cue before trips	Umbrella opening (far away)	☐
17	Stay — 1–2 steps distance; short recalls	Short departures (step outside)	Keep supervising closely	Bikes / skateboards passing	☐
18	Ping-pong recall indoors	Crate in a different room	Reward every success	Metal grate / bridge	☐
19	Stay — small distractions	Relaxed crate naps	Watch for sniffing signals	Hair dryer at low setting	☐
20	Hide-and-seek recall; leave it	Crate + stuffed toy while you leave home 15 min	Check log trends	People in uniforms	☐
21	Recall in fenced yard / long line	Review crate steps	Celebrate dry days	Friend's home visit	☐
22	Leash walking — reward position indoors	Crate during meals out of sight	Potty on leash at spot	Sidewalk at quiet time	☐
23	Leash on — hallway walking	Crate 30–60 min while home	Longer gaps if successful	Traffic from a distance	☐
24	Be a tree; wait at doors	Short absences	Keep rewarding outdoors	Stairs (a few, supervised)	☐
25	Leash in yard; direction changes	Crate while you run an errand	Potty cue works on command?	Park bench people-watching	☐
26	Leash on quiet sidewalk; sniff breaks	Crate nap routine	Review log	Wobbly surface / cushion	☐
27	Proof sit/down/stay outdoors	Bedtime routine	Maintain schedule	Groomer lobby visit	☐
28	Proof recall on long line	Crate with door open during the day	Fewer reminders needed?	Busier outdoor area (distance)	☐
29	Trade/drop; leave it outdoors	Evaluate crate comfort	Note overnight success	Calm adult dog walk	☐
30	Graduation: show off every skill!	Celebrate	Celebrate	Plan next month's outings	☐

EVERY DAY, NO MATTER WHAT

Follow the potty schedule • Give 2–3 food-stuffed or chew toys • Schedule naps • Reward calm behavior you like • Hand-feed part of a meal • End on a win.

Troubleshooting FAQ

Real answers to the questions puppy parents ask most.

Q. My puppy knows “sit” at home but ignores me outside. Is she being stubborn?

Almost certainly not. Dogs don't generalize well, and outside is full of exciting smells. Go back to an easier version of the skill, use higher-value treats, and increase distance from distractions. Practice in many places.

Q. How do I stop my puppy from jumping on people?

Ask guests to turn away and ignore jumping, and to greet only when all four paws are on the floor. Reward sits for greetings. Keep your puppy on leash when guests arrive so you can prevent practice.

Q. My puppy has accidents right after coming inside.

Your puppy may be distracted outside. Stay out a few minutes longer, keep potty trips boring until they go, and reward immediately at the spot. Supervise closely indoors for 15–20 minutes after a trip where nothing happened.

Q. My puppy cries at night in the crate.

Put the crate beside your bed for the first weeks, take a quiet potty break if needed, and make daytime crate practice pleasant. Most puppies settle within one to two weeks when routines stay consistent.

Q. My puppy gets the “zoomies” and bites every evening.

This is very common and often means overtiredness. Build in a calm chew or a nap before the usual witching hour, and use a gated area to help them rest.

Q. My puppy chews furniture and shoes.

Puppy-proof by picking up tempting items and using gates. Provide appropriate chew toys and rotate them. Trade for a treat when your puppy has something they shouldn't.

Q. Should I use a retractable leash?

Not for training. Retractable leashes reward pulling and can cause injuries. A 6-ft leash for walks and a long line for recall practice work much better.

Q. How many treats is too many?

Use tiny pieces and subtract training treats from meals. As skills become reliable, switch to intermittent rewards and use life rewards like play, sniffing and going outside.

Q. My puppy seems scared of new things. What should I do?

Go slower, add distance, and let your puppy observe without pressure. Pair new things with treats. If fear is intense or growing, talk to your veterinarian and a qualified behavior professional.

Q. When can we stop using treats?

Treats are your paycheck system. You'll phase from rewarding every time to rewarding randomly and using everyday rewards. Keep occasional jackpots for recall — forever.

Q. Is it too late if my puppy is older than 16 weeks?

Not at all. Dogs learn throughout life. Continue positive experiences and training at your dog's pace.

Q. When should I get professional help?

If you see growling, snapping, resource guarding, intense fear, or panic when left alone, contact your veterinarian first to rule out pain or illness, then a certified trainer or veterinary behaviorist.

Printable Progress Tracker

Print as many copies as you like. Post it on the fridge so everyone can see progress.

Rate each skill weekly: check **1** = learning with a lure/help, **2** = does it on cue at home, **3** = does it in new places.

Skill	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Notes
Name response	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Marker word	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Sit	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Down	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Release word	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Stay (5 sec)	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Stay (2 steps)	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Come (indoors)	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Come (yard / long line)	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Loose leash (indoors)	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Loose leash (outdoors)	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Leave it	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Wait at doors	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Trade / drop	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Settle on mat	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	
Crate calmly (10 min)	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	

Daily potty log

Record times and results for 7 days. Patterns will jump out quickly and help you plan trips.

Day / Date	Morning	Midday	Afternoon	Evening	Overnight	Accidents (time/place)

Weekly reflections

Week 1 — biggest win & what to practice next

Week 2 — biggest win & what to practice next

Week 3 — biggest win & what to practice next

Week 4 — biggest win & what to practice next



Great job, puppy parent!

You've just spent a month building communication, trust and fun routines with your new best friend. Keep sessions short, keep rewards flowing, and keep celebrating small wins. The habits you build now will pay off for years.

Keep training

Two or three 5-minute sessions a day keep skills sharp.

Keep exploring

Continue safe, happy new experiences all through the first year.

Keep it kind

Reward what you love to see, and your puppy will offer it more and more.

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